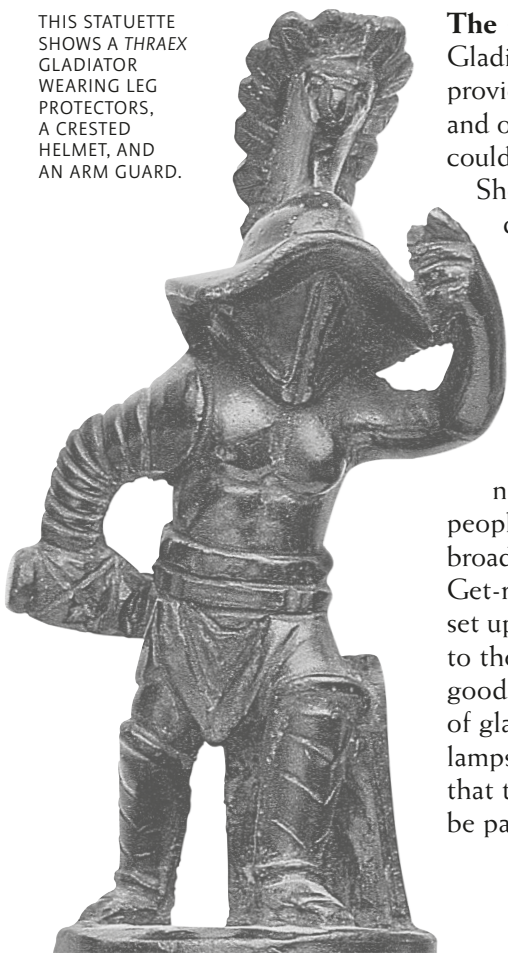


INTO THE ARENA

You are a trained gladiator at the peak of physical fitness. The day of the games is almost here, and you are to enter the arena soon. But how will you fight? Who will you fight, and what weapons will you use? Will you live to see another day? We can only guess what went through the minds of Rome's brave gladiators as they prepared for their few minutes of fame.

THIS STATUETTE SHOWS A *THRAEX* GLADIATOR WEARING LEG PROTECTORS, A CRESTED HELMET, AND AN ARM GUARD.



The show comes to town

Gladiatorial shows were provided for free to the public, and only the wealthiest Romans could afford to put them on.

Shows were advertised days before a troupe of gladiators reached town. Painted signs appeared on the walls, and the excitement of the public grew. Town criers walked the streets calling out the fighters' names and skills, and people carried banners broadcasting the same news. Get-rich-quick merchants set up souvenir stalls close to the arena, selling gladiator goodies—from pottery models of gladiators to decorated oil lamps. This build-up ensured that the amphitheater would be packed on the big day.